



World Investment Forum

Investing in Sustainable Development

Xiamen, China, 6-9 September 2010



WIF 2010 was organized by UNCTAD
in cooperation with the Ministry of
Commerce of the People's Republic of
China and the China International Fair for
Investment and Trade



MINISTRY OF COMMERCE
OF THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA







“The biennial UNCTAD World Investment Forum is the most important event of the international investment community and its stakeholders.”

Mr. Ban Ki-moon
Secretary-General of the United Nations

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Foreword

“Both public and private sector actors must ensure that economic development meets challenges set by the UN Millennium Development Goals, namely of bringing the bottom billion out of extreme poverty.”



The UNCTAD World Investment Forum has become a global gravity centre for high-level discussion and action on how to harness international investment as an engine of growth and development.

The increasing importance of this topic is reflected in the growth of the Forum itself. In just two years it has become one of the world's leading international investment events, attracting over 1,800 participants from 120 countries including Heads of State and ministers, global CEOs, heads of international organizations and civil society.

As I said in my opening remarks to World Investment Forum 2010 (WIF 2010), we are entering a new phase of globalization that recognises both the importance of investment to economic growth and the need to ensure investment leads to sustainable development. The theme of WIF 2010 was therefore 'Investing in Sustainable Development' and it was timely for three reasons:

- Firstly, the global economy is starting to emerge from a profound economic and financial crisis and faces a very different global investment landscape in which developing and transition economies now attract over half of the global investment inflows, and invest 28% of global outflows. The Forum provided crucial answers on how investors in developed and developing countries can face this new landscape, the importance of putting in place a new and balanced global policy framework for investment, and how the world's fragile growth can be sustained by both the private and public sectors.

- Secondly, the imperatives of a low-carbon economy brought about by the effects of climate change open up new opportunities in the green race for corporations and call for the integration of investment policies into a global regime of climate change mitigation. Participants jointly considered policies that could enable and encourage greater investment in this area, and catalyse more sustainable global development.

- Thirdly, while investment can bring about development, that process is not automatic. Both public and private actors must ensure that economic development meets the challenge set by the UN Millennium Development Goals, namely of bringing the bottom billion out of extreme poverty. At WIF 2010, participants resolved to ensure greater sustainable investments in the poor, for the poor and with the poor.

Beyond the individual sessions, WIF 2010 also provided unique opportunities for global investors and policy-makers to hold official bilateral meetings, network informally and exchange ideas which have led to new policy initiatives, partnerships and concrete investment projects.

I wish to thank the Government of China for hosting WIF 2010 and all of our partners for their support and inputs. I look forward to welcoming you to WIF 2012 in Doha, Qatar.

Dr. Supachai Panitchpakdi
Secretary-General, UNCTAD

Highlights

“World Investment Forum... played a positive role in improving the global investment environment and promotion of investment cooperation.”

H.E. Mr. Xi Jinping, Vice-President of China

The **World Investment Forum** is a high-level, biennial, multi-stakeholder gathering that is designed to facilitate dialogue and action on the world's key emerging investment-related challenges. WIF 2010 aimed to foster a better understanding of the development challenges and opportunities that the post-crisis investment landscape entails, and in that context, provided inputs into the formulation of a new generation of national and international investment policies that can bring about sustainable development and help achieve the UN Millennium Development Goals.

In its 8 high-level events and conferences, WIF 2010 brought together stakeholders from all angles of the investment community, including policy-makers, investors, negotiators, practitioners, investment promotion officials, solicitors, senior counsels, academic experts and representatives of civil society, as well as stock market managers, portfolio investors and sovereign debt managers. WIF 2010 attracted more than 1,800 participants from 120 countries and 16 international organizations – including 9 Heads of State, 4 Heads of international organizations, 79 Ministerial-level Officials, 116 senior business executives, and more than 250 other senior representatives from the public and private sector, as well as 250 media representatives.

On the first day, in the **World Leaders Investment Summit**, 6 Heads of State and 5 prominent Chief Executive Officers (CEOs), as well as former President Bill Clinton (via letter), reiterated the importance of sustainable investment as an engine of growth and in overcoming the multiple crises of food, energy and the economy.



H.E. Mr. Xi Jinping, Vice-President of China, welcoming participants to the WIF 2010 in Xiamen, China.

The **Ministerial Roundtable** stressed that redesigning investment policies is a must, rebalancing the rights and obligations of investors and States, and paying more attention to the interaction of investment policies with other public policies such as climate change and financial systems reforms.

These issues were also touched upon in the **High-Level Tripartite Conference** in which CEOs and chief strategists of transnational corporations (TNCs), senior government officials and heads of investment promotion agencies focused on the opportunities and challenges in the post-crisis investment landscape, including those related to the fight against climate change.